



Samsung Galaxy Z Fold2

The smartphone gets the new One UI 3.1 update to make multitasking easier. <http://digit.in/mar21-77>



Mysterious Malware

Apple users have been targetting by a malware, reportedly 30000 devices have been affected. <http://digit.in/mar21-78>

LG Tone Free FN7

Impressive noise-cancelling abilities

To kick off 2021, LG has launched the LG Tone Free FN7 true wireless earbuds that come equipped with ANC and are priced similar to the premium competitors.

Build and comfort

The LG Tone Free FN7 features a compact-mirror-shaped, circular charging case that slips easily into most pockets without bulging out too much. The case is lightweight, easy to open and glows blue to highlight its UV sterilization capabilities.

Interestingly, the blue light is only for aesthetic purposes, the actual sterilisation only occurs when the case is closed and on charge, which means you can't watch the magic happen.

The earbuds are in-canal ones with downwards extending stems. The top of the stems houses a touch button that allows users to control music playback and calls. The LG Tone Free FN7 packs in IPX4 water-resistant certification, so it can withstand some sweat and light splashes.

Features

LG offers their Tone Free app that allows you to do numerous things such as select an EQ preset, customise the EQ according to your needs, control ANC and Ambient Sound, customise controls, and more.

Then there's the distinguishing feature of the buds - the UVnano sterilisation technology that allegedly eliminates 99 per cent bacteria on the earphones. There's no mention of the technology is effective against the novel coronavirus, but it's a nice feature to have nonetheless. Our only gripe with this is that the case becomes exceedingly filthy due to the cleaning process.

The Tone Free FN7 also comes boasting other features such as Active Noise Cancellation (as we mentioned



above), Ambient Sound, Bluetooth 5.0 with AAC and SBC codec support, IPX4 rating, USB-C charging, mono mode (where you can use a single earbud independently) and wireless charging. Two features we did miss were aptX codec support, which allows for better sound quality and connectivity, and Bluetooth multi-point connection, where you can connect two devices to the buds simultaneously. At the 20K price point, it's disappointing to see LG skimp out on these features.

Active Noise Cancellation and Ambient Sound performance

The LG Tone Free FN7 pleasantly surprised us with its noise-cancelling abilities. The earphones deliver solid noise cancellation, coming relatively close to the class-leading Sony WF-1000XM3. They do a great job at cancelling out low-frequency rumble as you may hear on a plane or during road commute. Human voices are also suppressed to an impressive degree, however, high-frequency sounds such as a fast fan and mechanical keyboard are audible even with ANC. Overall, it's as good

as the Jabra Elite 85t's ANC and comes pretty close to the Sony and Bose TWS earphones.

Sound quality

The earbuds employ tiny 6mm drivers that do some pretty solid heavy-lifting. The sound quality, for the most part, is clear, precise and natural. However, at times, the earphones lack a bit of a dynamic punch, especially in the high-mids and highs.

The high-mids and highs are pretty underexaggerated which causes some genres of music to lack punch and drive. In Pull Me Under by Dream Theatre, the cymbals and hi-hats sound dull and lethargic.

This impacts the overall effectiveness of the track. So, the earphones aren't ideal for those who like to listen to rock music.

Battery life

The LG Tone Free FN7 has lacklustre battery life for its exorbitant

price. The earphones are capable of a decent 7 hours of battery life from the earbuds with an additional 2 charges from the case. However, if you do turn on Active Noise Cancellation, those numbers dwindle down to 4-5 hours of playtime.

Verdict

While it does do pretty well keeping up with the competition when it comes to ANC, the lack of detail in and the mediocre battery life makes it difficult for us to recommend.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | GOOGLE FAST PAIR SERVICE: Yes | USB C-TYPE (FEMALE): Yes | EARPHONE TYPE: Canal | DRIVER: 6mm dynamic | ANC AND AMBIENT MODE: Yes | MIC TYPE: Digital, Analog MEMS | NUMBER OF MICS: 3 pairs | MERIDIAN SOUND EFFECT: Yes | PRODUCT BATTERY CAPACITY: 55 mAh x 2 | BATTERY LIFE: 7 hours (earphones) + 14 hours (case) without ANC | CODECS: SBC and AAC | IP RATING: IPX4

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